

Literature

Plays
Poetry Reading
General Lit.
History of Lit
Poetry Study





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): General Lit.: Grades 11-12, History of Lit: Grades 9-12, Plays: Grades 9-12, Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

About Plays: Grades 9-12

Students read Shakespeare's plays with additional optional readings and extra helpings from the time period.

About Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

In addition to reading a variety of poems from 19th century authors, students read biographies of two famous 19th century poets and dive into Virgil's Aeneid.

About General Lit.: Grades 11-12

Journey into the 19th century via novels, short stories, personal narratives, fairy tales, and more. Students engage with a variety of authors and texts from and about the time period and reflect on literary techniques and the characteristics of multiple genres along the way.

About History of Lit: Grades 9-12

Using Marshall's and Long's spines along with a variety of primary sources and additional readings, the History of Literature course introduces students to literary movements and figures in the 19th century. The course prioritizes influential texts in the English-speaking world but also seeks to give students glimpses at literary developments across the globe.

About Poetry Study: Grades 11-12

This course helps students explore and enjoy poems on many levels; lessons include practice in both writing and reading poetry.

Plays: Grades 9-12

William Shakespeare (1564-1616) is perhaps the greatest writer in the English language. Reading and speaking his beautiful words will delight students as they learn his timeless stories, meet a variety of characters, enrich their minds, and instruct their consciences. Students will begin by simply enjoying the plays and later by writing short compositions, comparisons, and commonplace entries. Shakespeare covers the wide panorama of human experience through his nearly 40 plays; the comedies, tragedies, and histories that students read will spark their imaginations with stories that transcend time and culture.



Placement & Combining Tips

Plays: Grades 9-12

This year, this course is the same as Shakespeare for Grades 5-8 with the only difference coming in Extra Helpings and additional options for further study.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Students new or struggling in their relationship with poetry should use Grade 8 lessons.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

Some books shared with other high school grades. Literature, history, and geography lessons work in sync in Grades 9-12, so it is best to consider all three together when placing students.

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

Lessons are shared across high school grades with grade-specific assignments in the lesson plans as appropriate.

Poetry Study: Grades 11-12

Prerequisite: Grade 9 Poetry Study or a familiarity with a variety of poems and a strong working understanding of poetic forms and terminology. Note: the main text used is begun in

Grade 10 Poetry study, but students do not need to complete Grade 10 lessons before beginning this course.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	Plays: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	The Tempest The Tempest (Audio recording) Henry IV Part 2 Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording) The Winter's Tale The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)
9-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 2 times/week 15 min	Poetry The Aeneid The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar The Crescent Moon
11-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 2 times/week 30 min	Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass Up from Slavery James Jane Eyre The Count of Monte Cristo Short stories and other writings Things Fall Apart The Souls of Black Folk
9-12	History of Lit: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	American Literature English Literature for Boys and Girls History of Literature PDF

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Plays: Grades 9-12

- ☐ You may want to read "Shakespeare and a Christian Worldview," which is Ch.9 in the book Echoes of Eden – Reflections on Christianity, Literature, and the Arts by Jerram Barrs. This is an excellent overview of why Shakespeare is important for everyone to know, including Christians.
- ☐ If your students are new to Shakespeare, read the tips for beginners (Found in Appendix link)
- ☐ You may want to read a retelling beforehand so you are familiar with the play. (Suggestions found in Extra Helpings)
- ☐ Read the discussion questions and skim the summaries of each scene each week before the reading to help guide emphasis and discussion with your students.
- ☐ Consider purchasing puppets to use while reading to keep track of all the characters.

NOTE on VERSIONS

Students should have an unabridged copy that is not in a modern language edition, such as the ones linked in the program. The language complexity gets easier to understand with practice. (Note: Shakespeare's work does often contain bawdy jokes or off-color content that will go over the heads of students if left in its original form; a modern language version will lay it all right out there in plain, modern English.) We like the Folger editions because they are inexpensive, the

lines are numbered (making it easy to find your place), and they contain good notes. These are available on the Folger website as free PDFs as well, though the notes are omitted.

NOTE on CONTENT

Teachers are sometimes wary of reading Shakespeare with their students because the plays do contain material that they would deem inappropriate. The Alveary generally follows Mason's programs for younger students. That does not mean, however, that your student will never encounter anything unsavory. Our best advice is to read in such a way that these things are moved over quickly, without added attention being drawn to them. Mason assures us that Shakespeare provides students with rich language and character lessons that are unparalleled.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

☐ The Scarlet Letter (Term 1) and Sense & Sensibility (Term 3) both have helpful introductions and discussion questions (listed after each chapter or section of the book). Read these, whether or not you are able to read the full book, to give yourself the resources for rich discussions with your students. Reading Like a Serpent (linked in Extra Helpings) is also an excellent resource for students and teachers wishing to dive deeper into The Scarlet Letter.

☐ A note on challenging content: While the upper grades provide many wonderful opportunities for discussion and growth, these are not children's books. The Scarlet Letter (Term 1) wrestles with the nature of sin and adultery, Ramayana (Term 1) includes a more overtly sexual myth, which is skipped in Ch.1, and a few more sexual comments in Ch.2 when the prince (in typical mythological fashion) passes a test to claim his wife. Singing Bird (Term 2) also has a brief description of a sexual encounter in Ch.21 intended to humanize the characters in the middle of a horrific situation. Similarly, there is a passage in Octavian Nothing (Term 2), early in section 2, "The Pox Party," where Octavian (who is hungry for good books to read) is coerced into translating sexually explicit Latin texts in return for smuggled books from his master's library. There is one example of a sentence he was asked to translate given in the book, and he is disgusted with it. Additionally, prepare your students for hard themes, especially in Singing Bird and Octavian Nothing, including slavery, war, and the cruel and abusive treatment of people and animals. It is sobering to consider wickedness and suffering; encourage students to grieve, and long for and look to the person who can put things right, Jesus, who brings perfect justice and love.

These books have many living ideas, examples of incredible resilience, and more. But it is a good idea to plan to read and/or discuss these books alongside your student(s), especially since they may be assigned much harder texts, or texts from a much less morally aligned perspective in college classes, when they will need to know how to approach these situations wisely on their own without you there to guide them.

☐ One way to approach conversations about content is to ask your student their thoughts on the section or chapter with the sexual or violent content and bring up the fact that they might not have encountered something like it before. Then, ask why they think the author included it in the book. Or, you might discuss the importance of skimming over something.

☐ Term 3 reads are both long novels. Especially for Tale of Two Cities, allow students time to narrate and enjoy the story; only about half is scheduled over the term. If you want to finish the book, start it in Term 2 after Gulliver's Travels, or allow students to read on their own time and use the allotted lesson time for extended written narrations and reflection.

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

☐ Print off the History of Literature PDF, as students will need to annotate and mark up various sections throughout the year.

☐ Although sources were condensed into one PDF when possible, there are still quite a few outside links due to the number of primary sources referenced, so make sure your student(s) has/have access to the internet for their course.

Poetry Study: Grade 11

☐ You'll need a journal and a poetry anthology or two of your choice for this course, as well as the assigned book. A few suggested anthologies are listed in Extra Helpings.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Plays: Grades 9-12



The Tempest



The Tempest (Audio recording)



Henry IV Part 2



Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording)



The Winter's Tale



The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Poetry



The Aeneid



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar



The Crescent Moon

General Lit.: Grades 11-12



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



Up from Slavery



James



Jane Eyre



The Count of Monte Cristo

Short stories and other writings



Things Fall Apart



The Souls of Black Folk

History of Lit: Grades 9-12



American Literature



English Literature for Boys and Girls



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Literature: Grade 11

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Plays: Grades 9-12

∞ [Appendix: Ideas for Students New to Shakespeare](#)

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

∞ [History of Literature PDF](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Literature: Grade 11

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Introduction - Romanticism

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

What authors and books come to mind when you think about literature in 19th century? You may be familiar with terms such as the "Romantic period" or "Victorian period." Tell or jot down anything that comes to mind.

Over the year we'll learn about the lives and writings of people who wrote from about 1800-1900 AD. These individuals wrote in a wide array of genres: poetry, essays, short stories, plays, science fiction, mysteries, thrillers, children's stories, and more. When possible, the readings scheduled in History of Lit will align with what you are reading in your Poetry and General Literature courses.

We'll focus on authors who wrote in English but will also spend some time getting a taste for influential texts written in other languages as well. Every culture has significant texts and stories, so while we're limited in this course to English texts and texts translated into English, it's important to remember there is a world of books and literary traditions from cultures around the world which we don't have the time or often the language to read in this course!

English writings from the end of the 18th century into the first half of the 19th century are sometimes grouped together as part of the "Romantic Period." As with any generalization, this is a label scholars have put on the time frame as they look back, not something authors were so much thinking about consciously as they wrote, although as we will see, writers and poets from this period were often aware that their style of writing was something new.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: History of Lit PDF "The Romantic Period" p.#-# (7 pages)

- What are some of the themes to look out for when you read literature from the Romantic Period? How did Romantic writers break with the traditions of Classicism? Do you recognize any ideas about poets and poetry in this reading that are still current today? How would you say our time is different or similar? What "rules" define literature written in English today?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Transition from Classicism to Romanticism

→ INTRO

Towards the end of the eighteenth century, writers were beginning to break from the rules of Classicism and experiment with poetic subject matter and form that, in retrospect, seem more aligned with the themes of Romanticism. Today, you will read a few works by three poets who bridge these two time periods: Thomas Gray, William Cowper, and Robert Burns.

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard

- What is the setting of the poem, and how does Gray use this setting to create a mood or tone for the poem? What do you think the poet is saying about death and memory?

∞ Link: The Shrubbery

- How does the speaker show that there is a disconnect between how he feels and where he is? What is his relationship to the nature he sees around him?

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Term 1

∞ Link: To a Mouse

- If the language seems hard, try reading it out loud!
- This poem ends with a turn - why does the speaker see the mouse as "blest, compar'd wi' me!"?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 1

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

William Wordsworth

→ INTRO

We will learn more about William Wordsworth (1770-1850) in the History of Literature lesson next week, but today's reading should give you a feel for his style and major themes. As you read, compare Wordsworth's poem to the selections you read last time. "Tintern Abbey" is written in blank verse (unrhymed iambic pentameter, or ten syllables per line). What other poets have you read that use blank verse? How is this different than Gray's "Elegy" you read last week, that had a very rigid structure?

∞ Link: Lines Composed a Few Miles above Tintern Abbey, On Revisiting the Banks of the Wye during a Tour. July 13, 1798

- What are some images that especially stand out to you? What is Wordsworth saying about nature?
- What do you think he means when he says in lines 64-67: "here I stand, not only with the sense / Of present pleasure, but with pleasing thoughts / That in this moment there is life and food / For future years."?

→ VIEW

Look at this painting of Tintern Abbey painted in 1804 by English landscape painter William Havell (1782-1857).

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 2

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 1

📄 Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.87-89 "in the introduction" - "dynamic surprise."

- What do you think about the idea of poetry as friendship?
- Throughout this course, keep a personal anthology of poems that you've read and liked in your journal. Van Engen starts his book by encouraging us to browse an anthology until we come across a poem that we resonate with in some way, and then to start noticing what poems we like, expanding our circle of friends.

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you are jumping into this course, feel free to read the previous chapters on your own time. However, several sections in the upcoming chapter review some of the previous concepts, so it is perfectly fine to start here!

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 2

📄 Materials: Journal

→ REFLECT

Journal about this quote and reflection questions from p.263, "Ch.4, Think of Poetry Like Friendship, #1":

"If we think of approaching a poem like we might approach a friend, it changes the way we read it. We will pass over many people, many poems, until we find something we share. And very often that shared ground will nourish some form of pleasure or delight. But a good friend, in the end, always brings more than we bargained for. The more we spend time together and the more we converse, the more layers our conversations reveals (88)."

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

• Have you experienced a good friendship? Are you open to being surprised, nourished, challenged, and confronted? When has that happened? What does that look like? Have you experienced any sort of book or poem as a good friend before?

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls; History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the major themes of the Romantic Period from last week's reading?

→ INTRO

Today we will learn more about the life and work of two poets - William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge, who are most closely associated with English Romantic poetry.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Marshall, Ch.LXXIV "Wordsworth - the Poet of Nature."
 - How did Wordsworth's experiences as a child seem to influence his later poetry?
2. Marshall, Ch.LXXV "Wordsworth and Coleridge - the Lake Poets."
 - What are some similarities and differences between the two poets?

• IMPORTANT DATES

William Wordsworth (1770-1850)

Samuel Taylor Coleridge (1772-1834)

First publication of the Lyrical Ballads (1798)

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

With the anonymous publication in 1798 of their Lyrical Ballads, Wordsworth and Coleridge introduced a new style of poetry to the public. The initial publication received mixed reviews, however, and with each subsequent publication, the two poets included a Preface by way of an introduction to their style, themes, and purpose. In today's lesson, you will read excerpts from the 1802 edition of this preface, as well as a representative poem by each of them. Think about how the poetry you read illustrates some of the points made in the Preface.

→ READ & DISCUSS

1. ∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads (1802)
2. Wordsworth, "My Heart Leaps Up"
My heart leaps up when I behold
A rainbow in the sky:
So was it when my life began;
So is it now I am a man;
So be it when I shall grow old,
Or let me die!
The Child is father of the Man;
And I could wish my days to be
Bound each to each by natural piety.
3. ∞ Link: Wordsworth, "I Wandered Lonely As A Cloud"
4. ∞ Link: Coleridge, "The Rime of the Ancient Mariner"
 - NOTE: This poem is too long to read completely today, but reading it

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for a few minutes will give you a feel for the style. If you enjoy it, please finish reading it during the next poetry class or during your free reading time!

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 3

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4 *Samuel Taylor Coleridge*

→ INTRO

Today we are going to read a poem much different in style from *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*. As you read, think about other poems you have read about children, or by poets remembering their own childhood.

∞ Link: Frost at Midnight

With any time remaining, you can read more of *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*.

★ TEACHER TIP

There is a Poem Guide for Frost at Midnight at the Poetry Foundation link, if your student would like extra information about the poem or help with understanding it.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 4

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 3

📄 Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.89-91 "With that in mind" - "at once."

- Can you think of a time when you learned something unexpectedly from a friend?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 4

📄 Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Use your anthology of choice and read some poetry today. Look for a poem that might become a new friend! Start your personal anthology of poems you like in your journal.

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

Rabindranath Tagore

→ INTRO

If you are taking the Poetry Reading course this year, you will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher and artist Rabindranath Tagore. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century.

→ VIEW, NARRATE & DISCUSS

This video provides an excellent overview of Tagore's life and work. It will take nearly the entire lesson time to watch, although you can watch at 1.25x speed.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate

- What were some of Tagore's major contributions to arts and history?

→ READ

• IMPORTANT DATES

Rabindranath Tagore (1861-1941)

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

∞ Link: The Gardener 85

This short poem is a timely piece to read, since Tagore was still alive and writing a century ago.

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Rabindranath Tagore

📖 Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ INTRO

We will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher and artist Rabindranath Tagore. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century.

The Crescent Moon is a collection of forty poems exploring themes such as childhood wonder, the natural world, imagination. As you read through these poems, think about other poems you have read that present the world through the eyes of children, such as Robert Louis Stevenson's *A Child's Garden of Verses*.

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.6-7 "The Home"

- How would you describe the speaker of this poem?
- The poem opens with two examples of personification (a figure of speech which gives human characteristics to non-human things). Why do you think Tagore uses these images of a miser and a widow?

p.8 "On the Seashore"

- What images stand out most to you in this poem? How might they be symbols of a deeper meaning that lies beneath a simple description of children playing?

p.9-10 "The Source" and "Baby's Way"

- What do these two poems together seem to say about the nature of infants and children?

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you are not taking the History of Lit 9-12 course, you may wish to watch this introduction to the life and work of Rabindranath Tagore during some free time.

∞ **Video Link:** Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 5

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

📖 Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.11-16

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 6

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 5

📖 Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91-93 "To illustrate" - "it yields."

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Term 1

- Van Engen writes, "Poetry dwells, quite often, in pictures and particulars." Give examples of where you have seen this to be true in poems you have read.

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 6

Materials: Anthology

→ READ & REFLECT

Read more poems today. Read a poem that catches your attention at least twice and at least once out loud. What "particulars" does it contain?

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Sir Walter Scott

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ INTRO

E.M. Forster described Sir Walter Scott as a writer "over whom we shall violently divide," and certainly he has had his share of ardent readers and detractors. But one reason his works are still appreciated, as the literary critic Walter Allen said, is that "without being in the strict sense an historian, he revolutionized the writing of history." Today we will learn more about this author whom Virginia Woolf described as "perhaps the last novelist to practice the great, the Shakespearean art, of making people reveal themselves in speech," and of whom Jane Austen said, "Walter Scott has no business to write novels, especially good ones. It is not fair. He has Fame and Profit enough as a Poet!"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXVII "Scott - The Awakening of Romance

Ch.LXXVIII "Scott - 'The Wizard of the North'"

- What elements of Scott's subject matter and style seem distinctive to you?

→ READ

∞ Link: Lochinvar

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.17-22

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 7

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you

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like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.23-29

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 8

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 7

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.93-95 "The second image" - "by the dark."

- Have you ever reread a children's book or a poem that you hadn't read for years? Did you have the experience the author describes of meeting an old friend in a fresh way?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 8

Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ REFLECT

Read more poems and add to your personal anthology. What questions can you think of to ask your new friends?

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Percy Bysshe Shelley

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Sir Walter Scott from last week?

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets: Percy Bysshe Shelley, wife of Mary Shelley (the author of *Frankenstein*). If you are also taking the Poetry course, you will read some of his poetry this week. However, today you will also read an excerpt from his *Defence of Poetry*, a philosophical essay on the nature and function of poets and poetry.

Do you recall any details about Shelley from the overview of the Romantic Period you read in Week 1?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Percy Bysshe Shelley Biography

2. *Defence of Poetry*

- What are the main points Shelley is making in this excerpt? What images and arguments stand out to you the most? What do you think he means by "poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world?"

• COMPOSITION -

Compare/Contrast

Compare and contrast what you read of Shelley's *Defence to the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads*.

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

Rabindranath Tagore, *cont.*

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you



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like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.30-35

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 9

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Percy Bysshe Shelley

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets: Percy Bysshe Shelley. While he was inspired by the work and thought of Wordsworth and Coleridge, he has a style all his own. Look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The first two poems are sonnets: what do you already know about sonnets? How does the form support the meaning of the poem? Both these poems have guides, if you would like to read about them further.

∞ Link: Ozymandias

∞ Link: England in 1819

- What do you know about what was happening in English around the year 1819?

2. In these second two poems, consider how Shelley is representing nature.

∞ Link: Ode to the West Wind

∞ Link: Mont Blanc

- What poetic images stand out to you the most?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 10

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 9

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.95-98 "How do poems" - "misfortunes of life."

- Have you ever seen something out of the side of your eye that disappears when you look directly at it? Sometimes you can see faint stars with your peripheral vision that disappear when you look right at them. This is another way to think about poetry. Poems often tell us things through associations.

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Tell the truth but tell it slant by Emily Dickinson

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 10

Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ REFLECT

Read some more poems today. When you find one that makes you want to ask more, journal about all the associations it brings to mind.

WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5



Term 1

WEEK 6 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Percy Bysshe Shelley from last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

This article is fairly long. You may skim through the information about her early life with Percy Shelley, but be sure to read the excerpts of her travel writing and other prose towards the end of the article.

∞ Article Link: [Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley Biography](#)

- What aspects of Mary Shelley's character are evident in her writing? If you are reading *Frankenstein* this year, does knowing more about the author's life affect your reading of her work?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Shelley that you read in the last lesson?

What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.36-40

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 11

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

John Keats

→ INTRO

Today, we will meet the second of the second-generation Romantic poets: John Keats. As we did with Shelley, look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period. There is only one poem to read today, because your understanding and appreciation of it will increase with multiple readings. Read it through more than once on your own, and if you would like some interpretive help, there is a link to a Guide to the poem.

This poem, *Ode on a Grecian Urn*, is a famous example of ekphrasis, or the poetic descriptions of a work of art. As you read, think about how the poetry engages with other arts, such as sculpture and music. What does it have to say about the limits of any one art form, or, put more bluntly, what can poetry do that sculpture can't, and vice versa?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: [Ode on a Grecian Urn](#)

- The final enigmatic two lines have been an interpretive puzzle since Keats wrote this poem - what do you think he means by "Beauty is truth, truth beauty,—that is all / Ye know on earth, and all ye need to know." And why are they in quotation marks?

→ VIEW

It is helpful to have an image of what Keats is describing when reading the poem.

∞ Link: [Sketch of an Urn by Keats](#)

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 12

Literature: Grade 11

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 11

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.98-99 "Let me illustrate" - "with them."

- Reread "Those Winter Sundays", and start considering it with the questions Van Engen brings up from the last chapter.

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 12

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Reread "Those Winter Sundays" on p. 98-99, then answer the four main questions on p.99 (orally or in writing).

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

John Keats

Materials: English Literature for Boys and Girls

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXXI "Keats - The Poet of Beauty"

- What are some connections between Keats and other writers you have studied this term? Which excerpts of his writing did you enjoy the most in today's reading?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.
p.41-46

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 13

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

John Keats, cont.

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Link: Ode to a Nightingale

- What does the nightingale represent to Keats in this poem?

2. The other two poems by Keats are both sonnets written in response to other works of art. The first he wrote after reading George Chapman's translation of Homer, and the second in response to the Elgin Marbles (statuaries from the Parthenon) when they first were displayed at the

• EXTRA HELPING

The Elgin Marbles are controversial, and Greece has requested their repatriation. Read more about the controversy here.

∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles

Literature: Grade 11

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

British Museum.

∞ Link: On First Looking into Chapman's Homer

∞ Link: On Seeing the Elgin Marbles

→ VIEW

A slide show of the sculptures that Keats would have seen.

∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles at the British Library

WEEK 7 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 14

WEEK 7 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 13

□ Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.99-101 "But for the purposes" - "its sounds."

- Have you ever thought about sound in poetry beyond whether it rhymes at the end of a line?

WEEK 7 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 14

□ Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- Pick a poem you like and think about questions #5-7 on p.100. Not all poems use sound in the same way, but do you notice anything about your poem's sounds?

WEEK 7 □ 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

WEEK 8 □ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

WEEK 8 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

→ INTRO

Today we will learn about a Romantic poet from another part of the world - Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda - who was born in Cuba and lived in Spain.

WEEK 8 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 15

WEEK 8 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Lightning Dreamer

WEEK 8 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 16

WEEK 8 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 15

□ Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.101-102 "That story" - "reader as well."

- Discuss the sentence: "Poets write themselves into recognition."

Literature: Grade 11

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Term 1

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 16

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ CREATE

- Make a bookmark or infographic with Questions #1-7 on it to keep with you as you read more poetry.

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Lightning Dreamer

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 17

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.
p.47-50

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 18

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 17

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.103-105 "More largely" - "friendship expands."

- What experiences does "Those Winter Sundays" make *you* think of? Our imaginations are funny things. Have you ever thought about the fact that if someone says, "imagine a chair," to a group of people, everyone will imagine a chair? But if you ask them to describe what they are imagining, they will all describe different chairs. One person's chair is a rocking chair, another's is a bar stool, and another's is a lounge chair in a living room. Poems evoke certain connotations but bring up different resonances within each of us, depending on our experiences. And even similar experiences are still not identical for each of us.

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 18

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

- Discuss the last sentences of Ch.3. Have you seen poetry illuminate your own experience or the experience of others? In the last chapter, the author talked about how poems are meant to be shared and discussed. Read some more poems and share a poem with someone this week!

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

Literature: Grade 11

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Term 1

WEEK 10 📅 **30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10**

WEEK 10 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19**
Lightning Dreamer

WEEK 10 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 19**

WEEK 10 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20**
Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

📖 Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.51-54, anthems?

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 10 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 20**

WEEK 10 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 19**

📖 Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Read another poem and journal your thoughts on it using the 4 questions.

WEEK 10 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 20**

📖 Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Reread the poem from the last lesson and reflect on questions 5-7 on p.100.

WEEK 10 📅 **30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10**

WEEK 11 📅 **30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11**

WEEK 11 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21**
Lightning Dreamer

WEEK 11 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 21**

WEEK 11 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22**
Tagore - Fireflies

WEEK 11 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 22**

WEEK 11 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 21**

📖 Materials: The Word Made Fresh, anthology, and/or journal

→ CATCH-UP DAY

Use this lesson to catch up on lessons in this or another course. Or just spend some time reading poetry and noting down any more poems you like in your anthology.

Literature: Grade 11

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Term 1

WEEK 11 ☐ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 22

☐ Materials: The Word Made Fresh, anthology, and/or journal

→ CATCH-UP DAY

Use this lesson to catch up on lessons in this or another course. Or just spend some time reading poetry and noting down any more poems you like in your anthology.

WEEK 11 ☐ 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

WEEK 12 ☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

WEEK 12 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

Exam

WEEK 12 ☐ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 23

WEEK 12 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

Exam

WEEK 12 ☐ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 24

WEEK 12 ☐ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 23

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

WEEK 12 ☐ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

WEEK 12 ☐ 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

Literature: Grade 11

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for links.



Term 2

WEEK 1	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13	
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25	• IMPORTANT DATES Virgil (70BC - 19BC)
WEEK 1	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 25	
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26	
WEEK 1	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 26	
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 25 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → INTRO How many poetic forms do you know? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.106-109 "In chapter 3" - "make a poem." • What poetic forms can you think of that exist just in the Bible?	• EXTRA HELPINGS Read Ch.3
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 26 Materials: Anthology → REFLECT Read some poems this week and notice all you can about their form.	
WEEK 1	30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13	
WEEK 2	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27	
WEEK 2	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 27	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28	
WEEK 2	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 28	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 27 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.109-110 "Two things happen" - "which to sing." • Do you think there are still poetic forms yet to be invented?	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 28 Materials: Bible & Journal → READ & REFLECT Can you think of poets who have broken with tradition to invent a new form? Jot any down. Then spend some time reading more psalms today.	
WEEK 2	30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14	

Literature: Grade 11

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Term 2

WEEK 3	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29	
WEEK 3	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 29	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 3	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 29 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.110-113 "Questions" - "in control" • Can you think of any poems that turn a common phrase or verse slightly on its head?	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 30 Materials: Journal & Audio → LISTEN & REFLECT Begin listening to Van Engen and two others talk about Countee Cullen's poem that you read on p.111 ∞ Audio Link: Countee Cullen (listen to about half the podcast)	★ TEACHER/STUDENT NOTE This podcast talks about Countee Cullen's life and struggles to understand God. There is also a mention of the fact that he was likely gay.
WEEK 3	30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15	
WEEK 4	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 4	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 4	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 31 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.113-114 "What reasons" - "at his command." • Note how the discussion today about form ties back to the last chapter on poetry as friendship. As you make more friends with poems, old and new, it will be easier to recognize when a poet is using an older form or making an allusion to an older poem.	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 32 Materials: Journal & Audio → LISTEN & REFLECT Finish listening to Van Engen and two others talk about Countee Cullen's poem that you read on p.111. ∞ Audio Link: Countee Cullen (listen to about half the podcast)	

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WEEK 4 📅 **30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16**

WEEK 5 📅 **30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17**

WEEK 5 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33**

WEEK 5 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 33**

WEEK 5 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34**

WEEK 5 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 34**

WEEK 5 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 33**

📖 Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.114-116 "Knowing that" - "with form."

- Can you think of people who have done the same thing that Countee Cullen did with poetry in another field, such as art, music, food, or handicrafts?

WEEK 5 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 34**

📖 Materials: Anthology

→ **READ & REFLECT**

Look up more of Countee Cullen's poems today if you enjoyed the one we've learned about. Or go looking for more poem-friends in your anthology. Notice the formal features of a poem you read and like.

WEEK 5 📅 **30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17**

WEEK 6 📅 **30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18**

WEEK 6 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35**

WEEK 6 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 35**

WEEK 6 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36**

WEEK 6 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 36**

WEEK 6 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 35**

📖 Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ **INTRO**

Have you read anything by Langston Hughes before?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.116-119 "Today, most people" - "sing new songs."

- Discuss the last sentences of the section we read today.

WEEK 6 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 36**

📖 Materials: Journal & Audio

→ **LISTEN & REFLECT**

Explore more about Langston Hughes and the poem from this section of

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Term 2

the chapter. Begin listening to the podcast and finish on your own time if interested.

∞ Audio Link: Langston Hughes

- Compare Hughes' poem with the one by Countee Cullen on pg.111.

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 37

The Aeneid - Introduction

📄 Materials: The Aeneid

→ INTRO

What do you know about an "epic" – what are the connotations of the word more broadly, and what do you know about epics in literature?

Name any you have read and what you remember about epic conventions.

Virgil's Aeneid is an epic that owes much to Homer's two books, The Iliad and the Odyssey, which you may have already read in part or as a retelling. Chronologically, the story of The Aeneid picks up where the Iliad left off - with the fall of Troy - but Virgil lived 700-800 years after Homer, in a very different world. During Virgil's lifetime, the Roman Republic was coming to an - at times violent - end, and amid this uncertainty, Virgil looked backwards and chose the founding of Rome as his epic subject: following the Trojan Aeneas from the destruction of Troy to the founding of a new city.

C.S. Lewis, in his Preface to Paradise Lost, saw epics like the Iliad, the Odyssey, and Beowulf, as "Primary Epics": they are works written down after a long tradition of oral storytelling, and tell the story of heroic deeds in order that such deeds may be remembered. They are myth-making stories, far more concerned with the life of one hero - Achilles, Odysseus, Beowulf - than with the wider historical context.

However, Lewis argues that something new happens with Virgil, and the Aeneid is the earliest example of a "Secondary Epic": "one of the most important revolutions in the history of poetry." In The Aeneid, Lewis writes, Virgil "decides to take one single national legend and treat it in such a way that we feel the vaster theme to be somehow implicit in it. He has to tell a comparatively short story and give us the illusion of having lived through a great space of time. He has to deal with a limited number of personages and make us feel as if national, or almost cosmic, issues are involved. He must locate his action in a legendary past and yet make us feel the present, and the intervening centuries, already foreshadowed."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. This helpful introduction to the Aeneid should give you a clear overview of the context of the epic and the general plot before we dive into the poem itself. You can read some of it today (skip the three exercises), or refer to it as you are reading the poem if you feel stuck.

∞ Link: Introduction to Virgil's Aeneid

2. Book 1, lines 1-96 "Wars and a man I sing" - "King of Cloudbursts."

- Today is a short reading to allow you time to look up characters in the Pronouncing Glossary (p.424-484) and begin to make a character list, if you would find that helpful.

• COMPOSITION -

Compare/Contrast

Compare The Aeneid's opening Invocation to the Muse (lines 1-13) to the openings of The Iliad and The Odyssey.

∞ PDF Link: Iliad Opening Lines

∞ PDF Link: Odyssey Opening Lines

- How is Virgil both imitating Homer and also doing something very new?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 37

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WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 38

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading? How does Virgil open his epic?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 97-367 "With such thanks" - "the men of Troy."

- What have you learned so far about the Aeneas's character? Why do you think he "assumes a look of hope / and keeps his anguish buried in his heart?"

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 38

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 37

Materials: The Word Made Fresh & anthology

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.119-122 "One might think" - "always there."

- Look up and read some golden shovel poems.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 38

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ & REFLECT

Reread Gwendolyn Brooks' poem from the chapter and then read and reflect on Harjo's "American Sunrise". What do you notice about how these poems are related?

∞ Poem Link: "American Sunrise"

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Audio Link: American Sunrise Podcast

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 39

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 367-595 "But Aeneas, duty-bound" - "who dares to battle men."

- What have you learned so far about the gods? How do they interact with mortals?
- Why do you think Venus comes to Aeneas in disguise?
- Why does Aeneas have such an emotional reaction when he sees images of the Trojan War displayed in Carthage?

→ CLOSE READING

- 517-528: This is an example of an epic simile, which is an extended comparison. Here Virgil compares workmen making a theater to the labor of bees. Why is this a striking comparison?

- COMPOSITION - Descriptive
Try writing your own epic simile.
It can be in prose or verse.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 39

Literature: Grade 11

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 40

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 596-908 "And now / As Trojan Aeneas" - "and seas on earth."

- Why does Venus send Cupid disguised as Ascanius? Do you think Venus is trying to protect Aeneas, manipulate the situation, or both?
- Is Dido responsible for her eventual feelings for Aeneas if the gods interfere so heavily? What early signs in this passage hint that the relationship between Dido and Aeneas may become tragic?
- How much free will do mortals seem to have in the epic? This is a question to come back to as you read further.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Aeneas's son is called both Ascanius and Iulus.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 40

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 39

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.122 -124 "In the rest" - "successive lines."

→ READ

"Christmas Tree" poem by James Merrill

∞ Poem Link: "Christmas Tree" poem

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 40

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

Look up and enjoy more poems by George Herbert. Reflect on them using the model that Van Engen has given you.

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 41

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 1-255 "Silence. All fell hushed" - "nor all the thousand ships."

- Have you heard the phrase "beware the Greeks bearing gifts" before? Why do you think it has become an adage?
- Why do you think Virgil chooses to recount the fall of Troy through the narrative of Aeneas rather than directly? How do you see Aeneas's emotion shaping the story he tells?
- What role does Sinon play in this section?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 41

Literature: Grade 11

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WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 42

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 42

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 41

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.124-127 "If some poems" - "that results."

- Discuss the idea that "knowledge increases pleasure." Where have you seen this to be true in your life?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 42

Materials: Anthology, The Word Made Fresh, Journal

→ **REFLECT**

Read more poems and/or look back at poems you like and reflect on the ways form is at work in them.

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 43

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Book 2, lines 256-501 "But a new portent" - "they know so well."

- Can you find epic similes in this section? Why do you think there are so many of them in battle scenes?
- What is the significance of Aeneas dreaming of Hector's ghost? What message does Hector have for Aeneas?
- Why does Aeneas keep fighting even once it is clear that Troy is lost?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 43

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 44

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 44

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 43

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.127-132 "Other forms" - "invent his own."

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 44

Materials: Anthology, Journal

→ **READ & REFLECT**

Read more poetry and reflect on the ways form is at work. You may want

Literature: Grade 11

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Term 2

to look up more information on the poet and the poem's form since so many discussions on form rely on understanding its context.

WEEK 10 📅 **30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22**

WEEK 11 📅 **30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23**

WEEK 11 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 45**

The Aeneid, cont.

📄 Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 501-725 "But oh / how wrong to rely" - "bow to my commands."

WEEK 11 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 45**

WEEK 11 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 46**

WEEK 11 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 46**

WEEK 11 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 45**

📄 Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.132-135 "When considering" - "as depths."

WEEK 11 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 46**

📄 Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ & REFLECT

Van Engen writes, "Look for the sentences, find the periods. Contrast the grammar a poet uses with the stanza breaks and formal choices."

- Pick a poem to review or a new one you find in your anthology and follow Van Engen's instructions above.

WEEK 11 📅 **30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23**

WEEK 12 📅 **30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24**

WEEK 12 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 47**

WEEK 12 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 47**

WEEK 12 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 48**

WEEK 12 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 48**

WEEK 12 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 47**

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Literature: Grade 11

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Term 2	
Questions will come from: The Word Made Fresh	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 48 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Word Made Fresh	
WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24	

Literature: Grade 11

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 49

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 49

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 50

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 50

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 49

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.136-137 "If you want" - "links them?"

- Spend some time thinking about the author's questions yourself.

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 50

Materials: The Word Made Fresh & Journal

→ REFLECT

Write your thoughts on Bradstreet's poem. Why are the two stanzas put together? What links them?

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 51

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 51

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 52

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 52

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 51

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.137-139 "Whenever two" - "you notice?"

- STOP before reading the author's thoughts and answer his question-- What do you notice about the nouns now that most of the poem has been erased?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 52

Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Look back at a poem that has caught your attention or find a new poem in your anthology and practice erasure. You may want to look up the poem online and copy it into a document where you can manipulate the text more easily.

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

Literature: Grade 11

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Term 3

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 53

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 53

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 54

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 54

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 53

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.139-140 "Many of them" - "words are they?"

- Now give your thoughts on the verbs!

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 54

Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ **READ & REFLECT**

Using the same poem you started working on two lessons ago OR a new poem, practice focusing on just the verbs.

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 55

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 55

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 56

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 56

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 55

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.140-141 "Notice the suffering" - "adjectives and adverbs."

- Look at the poem's isolated adjectives and adverbs on p.141-142. How does this add meaning and focus?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 56

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Journal, Anthology

→ **READ & REFLECT**

Pick a poem (the same one from the last two weeks or a new one) and concentrate on the adjectives and adverbs.

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 57

Literature: Grade 11

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WEEK 5	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 57	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 58	
WEEK 5	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 58	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 57 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.142-143 "The adjectives and adverbs" - "nature_fate." • What do you notice about the repetitions now?	• EXTRA HELPINGS ∞ Audio Link: Anne Bradstreet Podcast
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 58 Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology, & Journal → READ & REFLECT Pick a new poem and choose a few things to focus on to see what you can notice: nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, repetition, etc.	
WEEK 5	30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29	
WEEK 6	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 59	
WEEK 6	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 59	
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 60	
WEEK 6	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 60	
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 59 Materials: The Word Made Fresh → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.143-146 "Elegies like this" - "a time." • Look back at the sonnet (p.144-145) and find where the sentences start and stop. Look at the first one and discuss everything you notice.	
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 60 Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology, Journal → READ & REFLECT Choose a poem you already like or find a new one and notice the punctuation and sentences.	
WEEK 6	30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 7	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 61	
WEEK 7	30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 61	
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 62	

Literature: Grade 11

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Term 3

WEEK 7 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 62**

WEEK 7 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 61**

📖 Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.147- 150 "Batter my heart" - "ravish."

- What did you think of all the different images in the poem? Discuss what you see by isolating the verbs.

WEEK 7 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 62**

📖 Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology, Journal

→ **READ & REFLECT**

Pick a new poem to reflect on and focus on the imagery in the poem.
Erase anything else you think might be interesting to notice further.

WEEK 7 📅 **30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31**

WEEK 8 📅 **30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32**

WEEK 8 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 63**

WEEK 8 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 63**

WEEK 8 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 64**

WEEK 8 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 64**

WEEK 8 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 63**

📖 Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.150-153 "As you glance" - "admit him."

WEEK 8 📅 **15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 64**

📖 Materials: Anthology

→ **READ & REFLECT**

Read some new poems in your anthology today and find a new one that connects with you.

WEEK 8 📅 **30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32**

WEEK 9 📅 **30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33**

WEEK 9 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 65**

WEEK 9 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 65**

WEEK 9 📅 **15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 66**

WEEK 9 📅 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 66**

Literature: Grade 11

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Term 3

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 65

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.153-154 "Erasure, as we" - "Christian care?"

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 66

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

"Look to the verbs. Isolate the nouns. Examine the adjectives. Erase for sentences. Pull out all repetitions or requests. Scrub away the poem according to the actions of each person or object." (p.153)

- Use erasure to consider another poem of your choice. You'll continue your reflections over the next two lessons.

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 67

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 67

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 68

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 68

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 67

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Continue your work with the poem from the last lesson.

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 68

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT

Continue your work with the poem from Lessons 66-67. How many different things have you discovered? Some poems will yield more insight from erasure than others, so you haven't done anything wrong if you don't come up with astonishing insights from these exercises. But all of them will help you understand the poem more deeply and train your attention.

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

WEEK 11 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 69

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 69

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 70

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 70

Literature: Grade 11

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WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 69

Materials: The Word Made Fresh and/or anthology

→ CATCH-UP DAY

Catch up on lessons, read more poetry, or peek at the rest of the book!

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 70

Materials: The Word Made Fresh and/or anthology

→ CATCH-UP DAY

Catch up on lessons, read more poetry, or peek at the rest of the book!

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

WEEK 12 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 71

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 71

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 72

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 72

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 11 - Lesson 72

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36